VTU MBA – FIRST SEMESTER

JNNCE, Department of Management Studies

MANAGERIAL COMMUNICATION

MODULE 1: FOUNDATIONS OF MANAGERIAL COMMUNICATION

Expanded, exam-oriented study notes

Definitions • Diagrams • Business examples • Applications • Model answer frameworks

Course Code: 33MBA106 | Scheme: 2026 | Semester: I

Module duration: 8 hours

1. Meaning, definition and nature of communication

Communication is the process of sharing information, ideas, opinions, feelings or instructions between people through words, symbols, behaviour or other channels, with the aim of creating a common understanding and achieving a purpose.

In management, communication is not complete merely because a sender has delivered a message. The receiver must interpret it sufficiently accurately for the intended action or understanding to occur.

1.1 Key features / nature

- Two-way and interactive: effective communication involves a response or feedback, not just one-way delivery.
- Purposeful: messages are sent to inform, persuade, instruct, coordinate, motivate or solve a problem.
- Continuous: managers communicate before, during and after decisions and activities.
- Dynamic and contextual: meaning can change with the situation, relationship, culture and channel.
- Verbal and non-verbal: words, tone, facial expressions, posture and gestures may all influence meaning.
- Symbolic: people use language, signs, numbers, images and gestures to represent ideas.
- Dependent on shared understanding: the sender and receiver need sufficiently common meanings.

1.2 Simple example

A manager emails employees: “Submit the report soon.” The message has been sent, but “soon” is unclear. One employee submits it that evening; another assumes the deadline is Friday. A better message is: “Please upload the sales report to the shared folder by 4.00 p.m. on Thursday, 12 November.” The second message reduces ambiguity.

Exam distinction Information transmission means sending data or a message. Communication is broader: it includes interpretation, shared meaning and feedback.

2. Role and purpose of communication

Communication is a core managerial activity. It helps managers connect organizational objectives with the work performed by individuals and teams.

Purpose / role	Explanation	Managerial example
Inform	Share facts, policies, instructions, updates or knowledge.	A manager informs staff about a revised attendance policy.
Persuade	Influence attitudes, opinions or actions through reasons and evidence.	A team leader explains why a new quality process should be adopted.

Instruct / direct	Explain what has to be done, by whom, how and by when.	A supervisor allocates daily production targets.
Coordinate	Align the work of people, teams and departments.	Marketing and operations coordinate stock before a festival sale.
Motivate	Encourage effort, commitment and confidence.	A manager recognizes good performance and explains team goals.
Build relationships	Develop trust, cooperation and a professional climate.	A manager holds regular one-to-one discussions.
Control	Communicate standards, review results and initiate corrective action.	A sales head discusses actual sales against targets.
Support decisions	Collect information, compare alternatives and communicate decisions.	A manager consults finance and operations before approving a project.

The Chaturvedi text particularly highlights communication to inform and to persuade. In a managerial answer, students can explain these two purposes first and then show how they support coordination, direction, motivation and control.

3. Classification of communication

Communication can be classified on different bases. In an examination answer, state the basis first. Do not mix categories from different bases into one unstructured list.

3.1 Based on participants

Type	Meaning	Example
Intrapersonal	Communication within oneself; internal thinking, reflection or self-talk.	A manager privately evaluates two project options.
Interpersonal	Communication between two individuals.	A manager gives performance feedback to an employee.
Group	Communication among members of a small group.	A project team discusses task allocation.

Mass	Communication directed to a large and dispersed audience.	A company-wide public announcement or press statement.

3.2 Based on mode / medium

Type	Meaning	Examples
Oral / spoken	Message communicated through spoken words.	Meeting, interview, phone call, presentation.
Written	Message communicated through written words or text.	Email, memo, report, circular, notice.
Non-verbal	Meaning communicated through cues other than words, often accompanying verbal messages.	Facial expression, posture, eye contact, gesture, tone of voice.

Verbal communication is often divided into oral and written forms. Non-verbal cues can reinforce, contradict or modify the meaning of spoken words. For example, saying “I am happy with the proposal” while displaying an irritated expression may create doubt.

3.3 Based on organizational formality

Type	Meaning	Examples / features
Formal	Communication through officially recognized organizational channels.	Policy circular, official report, scheduled review meeting.
Informal	Unofficial communication arising through personal and social relationships.	Workplace chat and grapevine; may spread quickly but can distort information.

3.4 Other useful classifications

- By direction: downward, upward, horizontal (lateral) and diagonal communication. These are explained in Section 8.
- By feedback: one-way communication (no immediate response expected) and two-way communication (response and clarification are possible).

Exam tip A strong classification answer can use a small tree diagram and then explain each category with one example.

4. Communication process

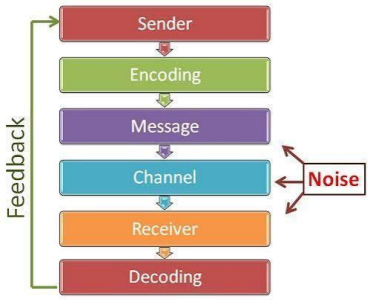
The communication process explains how an idea is converted into a message, sent through a channel, interpreted by a receiver and checked through feedback.

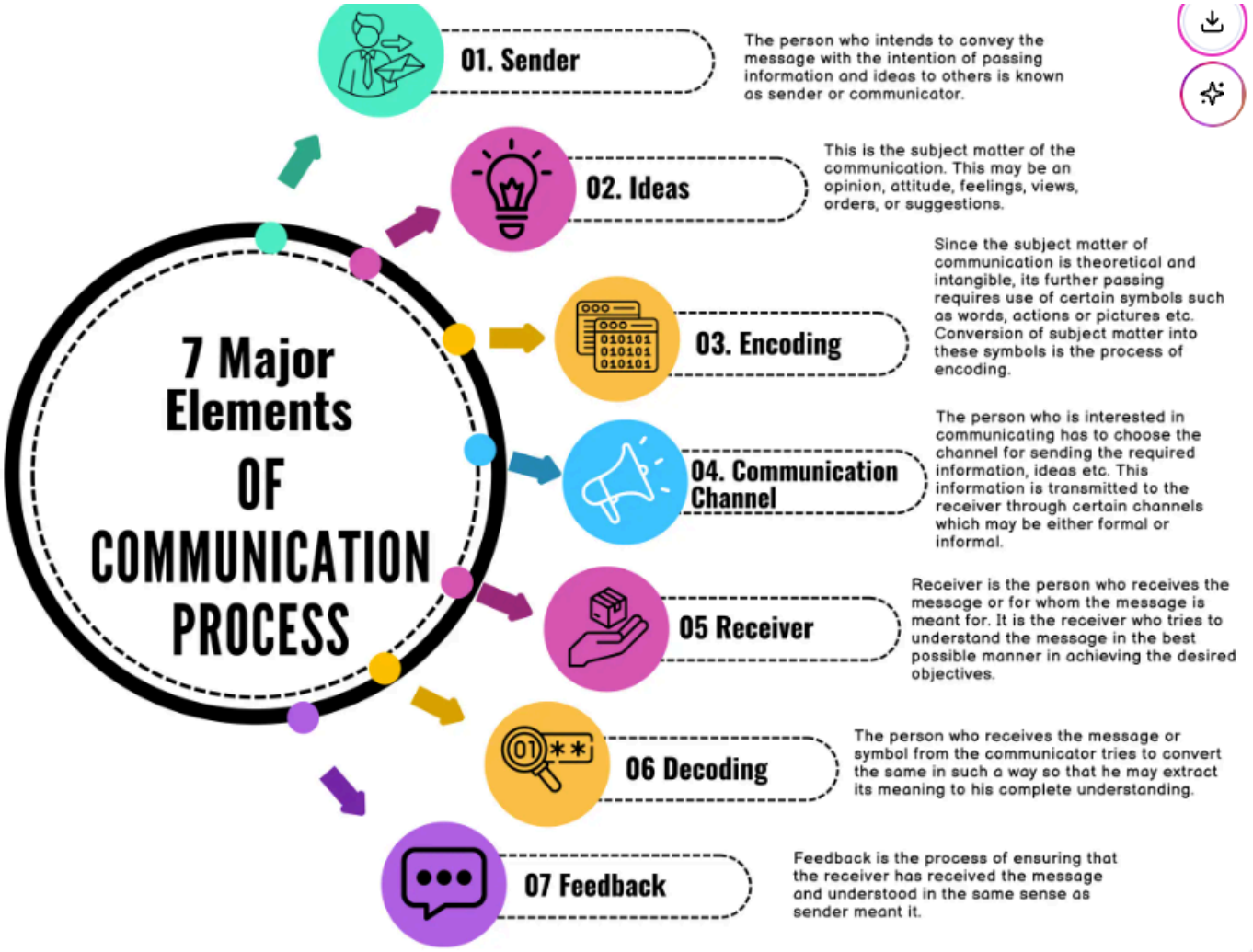
SENDER → ENCODING → MESSAGE → CHANNEL → RECEIVER → DECODING → UNDERSTANDING

↑_____↓

FEEDBACK

Noise may affect any stage of the process.





Element	Explanation	Example
Sender	Person or source that initiates communication.	Sales manager.
Idea	Thought, information or intention the sender wants to convey.	Increase monthly sales by 10%.
Encoding	Converting the idea into words, symbols, figures or gestures.	Preparing a clear target email.
Message	The actual content being communicated.	Target, deadline and performance expectations.
Channel	Medium used to carry the message.	Email, meeting, phone or video call.
Receiver	Person or group for whom the message is intended.	Sales team.

Decoding	Interpreting and assigning meaning to the message.	Employees understand the target and deadline.
Feedback	Receiver's response that helps the sender assess understanding.	Team acknowledges the target and asks questions.
Noise	Any factor that interferes with transmission or interpretation.	Poor audio, jargon, distraction or assumptions.

4.1 Types of noise

Noise type	Meaning and example
Physical noise	External disturbance such as construction noise during a meeting.
Technical / channel noise	Poor internet connection, microphone failure or an unreadable attachment.
Semantic noise	Different interpretations of words, abbreviations or technical terms.
Psychological noise	Stress, anger, fear, prejudice or lack of trust affecting interpretation.
Physiological noise	Hearing difficulty, illness, fatigue or other physical conditions affecting communication.

4.2 Linear and two-way communication

Linear communication is one-way: a sender transmits a message to a receiver. It may be suitable for a simple announcement, but it does not by itself confirm understanding.

Two-way communication includes feedback. It allows the receiver to ask questions, clarify doubts and respond. It is especially useful for instructions, change communication, performance discussions and problem-solving.

4.3 Worked example

A college principal asks faculty members to submit internal assessment marks by a specified date. The principal (sender) prepares the instruction (encoding), sends it through the official email system (channel), and faculty members (receivers) interpret it (decoding). Faculty members acknowledge the email and ask whether marks should be entered in the portal or sent as a spreadsheet (feedback). The clarification prevents errors. If the email contains an unclear deadline or the portal link is broken, noise interferes.

Exam tip For a 10-mark answer, draw the process diagram, explain all elements in sequence, distinguish feedback from noise and provide one complete example.

5. Characteristics of successful communication: The Seven Cs

The supplied Chaturvedi text presents the Seven Cs as practical conditions for effective communication. Use the exact terminology below when answering from this reference.

Seven C	Meaning	Example / application
Candidness	Honest, sincere and fair communication; avoid bias or deliberate concealment.	A manager explains the actual reason for a project delay rather than blaming an individual unfairly.
Clarity	Use familiar, precise words and organize ideas logically.	Replace “finish it soon” with “submit by 3 p.m. on Monday.”
Completeness	Provide all information the receiver needs to understand or act.	An event instruction includes date, venue, reporting time, dress code and contact person.
Conciseness	Use only the words necessary; avoid repetition without omitting essential details.	A short email with a clear subject, action and deadline.
Concreteness	Be specific and definite rather than vague or abstract.	“Customer complaints fell from 40 to 25” instead of “complaints reduced significantly.”
Correctness	Ensure facts, figures, names, grammar and details are accurate.	Verify the meeting date, attachment and recipient list before sending.
Courtesy	Use a respectful, considerate and professional tone.	“Please share the revised file” rather than “You failed to send it again.”

The Seven Cs reinforce one another. A message may be concise but incomplete; it may be clear but factually incorrect. Effective communication requires an appropriate balance.

6. Importance of communication in management

Communication connects managerial functions and enables people to understand organizational goals, responsibilities, standards and results.

Management function	How communication supports it	Example

Planning	Communicates objectives, assumptions, priorities, plans and deadlines.	Management explains the annual sales plan.
Organizing	Clarifies roles, responsibilities, authority and reporting relationships.	A project manager assigns responsibilities to team members.
Staffing	Supports recruitment, selection, induction, training and performance feedback.	HR explains job expectations to a new employee.
Directing / leading	Provides instructions, coaching, motivation and leadership.	A manager explains a new process and encourages adoption.
Controlling	Communicates standards, compares actual performance with targets and explains corrective action.	A production manager reviews defect rates and corrective steps.

Communication also supports decision-making by collecting information from different levels, coordination between departments, change management, employee engagement, customer relationships and organizational learning.

Example: When a company introduces a new billing system, management must explain why the system is changing, train employees, gather feedback, coordinate IT and finance, and communicate how problems will be resolved. Without communication, even a technically sound change may fail.

Exam tip Organize the answer around the five management functions—planning, organizing, staffing, directing and controlling—then add decision-making and coordination.

7. Communication structure in an organization

Organizational communication structure describes how information flows between people, levels and departments.

7.1 Communication by direction

Flow	Direction	Purpose and example
Downward	Higher level to lower level.	Policies, instructions, targets and performance expectations; e.g., a department head

		communicates a revised timetable.
Upward	Lower level to higher level.	Reports, suggestions, concerns and feedback; e.g., employees report a recurring customer complaint.
Horizontal / lateral	Between people or departments at the same or similar level.	Coordination; e.g., marketing and operations agree on product availability.
Diagonal	Across departments and different hierarchical levels.	Direct coordination where work requires it; e.g., a finance analyst contacts a project manager in another department to clarify budget data.

7.2 Formal and informal structures

Formal communication follows approved channels and provides accountability, consistency and an official record. Informal communication develops through social relationships and workplace interaction. It can be quick and useful, but rumours and distortion may spread when formal communication is delayed or incomplete.

7.3 Common organizational network patterns (additional understanding)

Network	Description	Possible strength / limitation
Chain	Information moves through a sequence of reporting relationships.	Clear hierarchy; may be slow and may filter information.
Wheel	A central person communicates with all other members.	Fast central coordination; dependence on one person.
Circle	Each member communicates mainly with adjacent members.	Can support participation; information may take longer to circulate.
All-channel	Members communicate freely with one another.	Useful for collaborative problem-solving; can become difficult to coordinate in large groups.

These network patterns are useful supplementary concepts for understanding how communication is organized. The syllabus specifically requires organizational structures; prioritize downward, upward, horizontal and formal/informal communication in the main examination answer.

Practical example If a sales employee reports a customer issue to the sales manager, it is upward communication. If the sales manager gives a new target to the employee, it is downward. If sales and logistics managers coordinate a delivery, it is horizontal. If a junior finance analyst contacts a senior project manager in another function, it may be diagonal.

8. Communication in conflict resolution

Conflict occurs when individuals or groups perceive differences in goals, interests, values, expectations or access to resources. Communication can either intensify conflict or help parties understand the issue and work towards a solution.

The Chaturvedi reference explains the S-TLC approach: Stop, Think, Listen and Communicate. It emphasizes that conflict resolution requires collaborative effort; one party's communication competence alone may not be sufficient.

S-TLC step	What to do	Workplace illustration
Stop	Pause before reacting. Regain self-control and avoid an impulsive response.	A manager does not reply angrily to a critical email.
Think	Consider the issue, background, goals, options, timing and the other person's perspective. Separate the issue from the person.	The manager checks whether the missed deadline resulted from unclear ownership or a genuine delay.
Listen	Hear the other party patiently. Do not assume you already know their reasons.	The manager asks each team member to explain the dependency that caused the delay.
Communicate	Express concerns clearly and respectfully; discuss options and agree on action.	The team agrees on revised ownership, deadlines and a weekly progress check.

8.1 Helpful communication behaviours during conflict

- Focus on the problem or behaviour, not on attacking the person.

- Use “I” statements to explain one's own concern and responsibility: “I was concerned because I did not receive the figures before the review.”
- Ask open questions: “What prevented the report from being completed?”
- Listen actively and paraphrase: “So your team was waiting for the inventory data—is that correct?”
- Agree on specific next steps, responsibilities and timelines.

Example: Two employees disagree about responsibility for a delayed customer order. Instead of assigning blame immediately, the manager pauses, reviews the order timeline, listens to both employees, identifies the hand-off failure and agrees on a clearer escalation process.

Exam tip Remember the exact sequence S-TLC. Explain why each step matters and show how the method changes a blame-oriented conversation into collaborative problem-solving.

9. Communication in crisis management

A crisis is an unexpected or serious situation that threatens people, operations, reputation, assets or the continuity of an organization. Crisis communication is the timely, accurate and coordinated sharing of information with affected stakeholders during such a situation.

9.1 Steps in crisis communication

1. Verify facts: establish what has happened, what is affected and what is still unknown.
2. Identify stakeholders: employees, customers, suppliers, regulators, media and the public, as relevant.
3. Coordinate responsibility: identify the authorized spokesperson or communication owner.
4. Communicate promptly: do not allow avoidable silence to create confusion or rumours.
5. State known and unknown information: do not speculate or make unsupported promises.
6. Give clear instructions: explain what stakeholders should do, avoid or expect.
7. Provide regular updates: state when and where the next update will be shared.
8. Review and recover: correct inaccurate information, explain recovery steps and learn from the incident.

9.2 Principles of effective crisis communication

Principle	Why it matters
Speed with accuracy	A prompt response matters, but unverified information can worsen the crisis.
Clarity	People need understandable information and practical instructions.
Consistency	Different departments should not issue contradictory messages.
Empathy	Acknowledge the impact on affected people; avoid sounding defensive.

Transparency	Explain what is known, what is not known and what is being done.
Regular updates	Tell stakeholders when they can expect further information.

9.3 Example: Online examination system failure

Suppose a university's online examination portal becomes unavailable during an examination. The university should verify the technical issue, identify affected students and examination centres, issue an authorized notice, explain whether students should wait or stop the attempt, clarify how lost time or submissions will be handled, and announce the next update time. It should not speculate about the cause before it is verified.

Other suitable examples include a product recall, workplace accident, cyberattack, data leak, natural disaster or sudden disruption to a supply chain.

Exam tip A strong answer distinguishes facts, unknowns, immediate action and the next update. A crisis message should not make promises that the organization cannot guarantee.

10. Communication and negotiation

Negotiation is a communication process in which two or more parties discuss their needs, interests, constraints and possible options to reach an agreement or manage a disagreement.

10.1 Stages of negotiation

Stage	Communication activities	Example
Preparation	Identify the issue, objectives, interests, facts, alternatives, limits and the people involved.	A supplier and buyer review delivery data, quality requirements and acceptable prices before meeting.
Discussion / negotiation	Ask questions, listen, clarify interests, make proposals, explain reasons and explore trade-offs.	The buyer requests a lower price while the supplier explains higher raw-material costs; both explore volume discounts.
Agreement and implementation	Record agreed terms, responsibilities, deadlines and follow-up arrangements.	Both parties confirm price, quantity, delivery dates, payment terms and escalation process.

10.2 Distributive and integrative negotiation (useful additional concept)

Approach	Meaning	Example
Distributive negotiation	Often treated as a fixed-pie situation: each party tries to secure a larger share of a limited value.	Buyer and seller bargain over the price of a single item.
Integrative negotiation	Parties explore interests and options to create mutual value, rather than focusing only on one demand.	A buyer offers a longer contract and predictable volume in exchange for better pricing and service levels.

A position is what a party says it wants; an interest is the underlying reason. For example, a supplier's position may be “We cannot reduce the price.” Its interest may be protecting its margin because input costs have increased. Understanding interests can reveal options such as volume commitments, phased delivery or revised payment terms.

10.3 Communication skills in negotiation

- Prepare facts and objectives before the meeting.
- Ask questions and listen to understand the other party's interests.
- Use clear, respectful and specific language.
- Separate people from the problem; avoid personal attacks.
- Summarize proposals and check that both parties interpret them in the same way.
- Confirm the final agreement in writing, including responsibilities and dates.

Exam tip Explain negotiation as a process, not merely as bargaining. Include preparation, discussion, agreement and implementation.

11. Communication in a cross-cultural setting

Cross-cultural communication takes place when people from different cultural backgrounds interact. Differences in language, values, social expectations, hierarchy, context, time orientation and personal space can influence how a message is expressed and interpreted.

11.1 Cultural sensitivity and cultural intelligence

Cultural sensitivity means recognizing and respecting cultural differences without treating one's own practices as universal. Cultural intelligence is the ability to understand unfamiliar cultural situations and adapt one's behaviour and communication appropriately.

11.2 High-context and low-context communication

High-context tendency	Low-context tendency
More meaning may be carried by context, relationships, shared understanding and non-verbal cues.	More meaning is expressed explicitly through words and detailed explanations.
Messages may be indirect; relationship-building and trust can be important.	Messages may be direct, explicit and task-focused.
A person unfamiliar with the unwritten expectations may misunderstand the message.	Written details and explicit clarification can reduce ambiguity.

These are broad tendencies discussed in intercultural communication literature, not fixed rules about every person in a country. Individuals, organizations and situations differ.

11.3 Areas where cultural differences may affect communication

Area	Possible misunderstanding	Better managerial practice
Language	Idioms, accents or jargon may be misunderstood.	Use plain language; avoid idioms; confirm understanding.
Hierarchy and status	Some employees may hesitate to disagree openly with a senior person.	Invite views respectfully and provide more than one way to give feedback.
Time	Different expectations about punctuality, deadlines or scheduling.	State dates, time zones and deadlines explicitly.
Personal space and gestures	A gesture or physical distance may be interpreted differently.	Observe local expectations and avoid assuming a gesture has universal meaning.
Silence and participation	Silence may be interpreted as agreement, disagreement or a need for reflection.	Ask for explicit confirmation and invite questions.
Relationship and trust	Some interactions may require relationship-building before business discussion.	Allow time to establish rapport and understand expectations.

11.4 Practical example

A manager conducts a virtual meeting with colleagues from several countries. After asking whether everyone agrees, the manager receives no objections and assumes the plan is accepted. Later, team members raise

serious concerns. The manager should not interpret silence automatically as agreement. The manager can invite each person to comment, ask specific questions, allow written feedback after the meeting and confirm decisions and action owners in writing.

Exam tip Avoid stereotypes. Explain cultural differences as possible influences, then recommend observing, asking, adapting and confirming understanding.

12. Barriers to effective communication and remedies

A communication barrier is any factor that prevents a message from being sent, received or interpreted as intended. Barriers can arise from the sender, message, channel, receiver or organizational environment.

Barrier	Meaning and example	Remedies
Incorrect assumptions	A manager assumes employees already know a new procedure and gives no explanation.	State the context, check prior knowledge, invite questions and confirm understanding.
Semantic / language	Jargon, ambiguous words or different meanings cause confusion; “ASAP” is interpreted differently.	Use simple and precise words, define technical terms and specify dates or quantities.
Psychological	Fear, anger, stress, prejudice or lack of trust affects how a message is received.	Build trust, use respectful language, choose an appropriate time and encourage open discussion.
Status / hierarchy	Junior employees hesitate to report mistakes or challenge a senior manager.	Create safe feedback channels, invite dissent and respond constructively to concerns.
Cultural	Different norms about directness, silence, hierarchy or gestures cause misunderstanding.	Develop cultural awareness, avoid stereotypes and clarify expectations.
Physical	Noise, distance, poor room acoustics or interruptions disrupt communication.	Choose a suitable location, reduce distractions and provide written follow-up.
Technical / channel	Weak internet, microphone failure or a broken link prevents the message from reaching the receiver.	Test technology, choose an appropriate channel and keep a backup method.

Information overload	Too many emails, notices or details make important information difficult to identify.	Prioritize key information, use headings and summaries, and send only relevant details.
Organizational	Too many layers, unclear reporting lines or departmental silos delay information.	Clarify communication routes, simplify approvals and encourage cross-functional coordination.
Poor listening	The receiver interrupts, multitasks or forms conclusions before hearing the full message.	Practise active listening, paraphrase, ask questions and remove distractions.
Poor message design	The message lacks structure, purpose, context or a clear action.	Organize the message, state the purpose, identify the action owner and specify the deadline.

12.1 General methods to improve communication

- Know the audience: consider the receiver's role, knowledge, language and information needs.
- Choose the right channel: use a meeting for sensitive discussion, a written record for formal decisions and an urgent channel for immediate safety instructions.
- Use simple and specific language: avoid unnecessary jargon and vague expressions.
- Encourage feedback: ask the receiver to summarize the action or raise questions.
- Listen actively: pay attention, avoid interrupting and clarify meaning.
- Create psychological safety: ensure people can report errors and concerns without unreasonable fear.
- Reduce information overload: highlight decisions, owners, deadlines and next steps.
- Follow up: document important decisions and check whether the intended action occurred.

High-scoring answer approach For a 10-mark question on barriers, define the term, classify or list the barriers, explain each with an example, suggest a remedy for each and conclude that communication must be planned for both the sender and receiver.

13. Integrated case studies for application

Case 1: Communication breakdown in a hospital

A hospital introduces a revised patient-discharge procedure. Administration sends a long circular to all departments. Nurses interpret one step differently from doctors. The pharmacy receives the change late. Patients experience delays and staff blame one another.

Questions for students:

- Identify at least four communication problems.
- Map the failure to the communication process.
- Which barriers are present?
- How should downward, upward and horizontal communication be improved?
- Suggest three immediate managerial actions.

Suggested analysis:

- Feedback was inadequate; receivers interpreted the instruction differently.
- Cross-functional coordination was weak and the pharmacy received the message late.
- Possible barriers include information overload, assumptions, semantic ambiguity, organizational silos and status barriers.
- Use role-specific instructions, a joint briefing, acknowledgement of receipt, an escalation route and a single updated procedure.
- Nominate a communication owner, issue a corrected step-by-step instruction and verify that every department has understood it.

Case 2: Product launch at risk

A company discovers a serious defect two days before launch. Engineering wants more time. Marketing has announced the date. Sales has promised customers availability. The product manager must recommend a response.

Questions:

- What facts must be verified before communicating externally?
- Who are the internal and external stakeholders?
- How should the manager communicate internally?
- How can negotiation resolve the engineering–marketing conflict?
- Which communication barriers are likely?

Suggested analysis:

- Verify defect severity, affected versions, customer impact and realistic remediation time.
- Stakeholders may include engineering, quality, marketing, sales, customers, suppliers and senior management.
- Use a coordinated internal update that distinguishes verified facts, unknowns, actions and the next update time.
- Identify interests: engineering needs product quality and risk control; marketing needs customer trust and a credible launch plan. Explore a delayed launch, phased release or other safe options.
- Likely barriers include departmental silos, conflicting priorities, assumptions, status pressure and information gaps.

Case 3: Cross-cultural virtual team

A manager leads a virtual team across India, Germany and Japan. The manager interprets silence in meetings as agreement. Later, several members reveal unresolved concerns.

Questions:

- What assumption did the manager make?
- How can context and communication norms affect participation?
- What should the manager change?
- How can feedback and agreement be verified?

Suggested analysis:

- Silence should not automatically be treated as agreement.
- People may differ in their comfort with public disagreement, directness or taking time to formulate a response.
- Invite comments, ask specific questions, allow written input and conduct individual check-ins where appropriate.
- Record decisions, ask participants to confirm action items and invite corrections before closing the issue.

14. VTU-oriented practice question bank

The following questions are practice questions mapped to the supplied Module 1 syllabus. They are not predictions of the examination paper.

Marks	Practice questions
3	Define communication.
3	What is feedback in the communication process?
3	What is meant by noise?
3	Define cross-cultural communication.
3	What is the purpose of communication?
3	Expand S-TLC and state its purpose.
7	Classify communication and explain with suitable examples.
7	Explain the Seven Cs of successful communication.
7	Explain the importance of communication in management.
7	Describe downward, upward, horizontal and diagonal communication.

7	Explain the S-TLC approach to conflict resolution.
7	Explain communication in a cross-cultural setting.
7	Explain the stages of negotiation.
7	Discuss barriers to effective communication and suggest remedies.
10	Explain the communication process with a neat labelled diagram.
10	Discuss the role and importance of communication in management.
10	Explain organizational communication structures with suitable examples.
10	Explain crisis communication and the principles of an effective crisis response.
10	Elucidate the barriers to communication and explain suitable corrective measures.
10	Explain the characteristics of successful communication with examples.

16. Last-minute revision sheet

Topic	Remember
Communication	Sharing meaning for a purpose—not merely sending information.
Purpose	Inform, persuade, instruct, coordinate, motivate, build relationships and control.
Classification	By participants, mode, organizational formality and direction.
Process	Sender → encoding → message → channel → receiver → decoding → understanding; feedback checks understanding; noise interferes.
Seven Cs	Candidness, Clarity, Completeness, Conciseness, Concreteness, Correctness, Courtesy.
Management	Communication supports planning, organizing, staffing, directing and controlling.

Organization	Downward, upward, horizontal and diagonal; formal and informal.
Conflict	S-TLC = Stop, Think, Listen, Communicate.
Crisis	Verify facts, identify stakeholders, communicate known/unknown information, give instructions, update and recover.
Negotiation	Prepare, discuss and explore options, agree, implement and follow up.
Cross-cultural	Cultural sensitivity, context, language, time, space, hierarchy; avoid assumptions and stereotypes.
Barriers	Assumptions, semantic, psychological, cultural, physical/technical, status, organizational, overload and poor listening; provide remedies.

17. Reference and scope note

Primary syllabus: VTU MBA 2026 Scheme, Managerial Communication, course code 33MBA106, Semester I, Module 1: Foundations of Managerial Communication (8 hours), supplied syllabus PDF, page 16.

Principal conceptual reference: P. D. Chaturvedi and Mukesh Chaturvedi, Business Communication: Skills, Concepts, and Applications, Pearson. Particularly relevant chapters: Chapter 8 (Nature and Process of Communication), Chapter 9 (Organizational Communication), Chapter 10 (Cross-cultural Communication), Chapter 16 (Communication for Conflict Management) and Chapter 17 (Communication for Effective Negotiations).

Additional supplied references include Shruti D. Naik, Business Communication: A Practical Approach; Lesikar, Flatley and Rentz, Business Communication; and Guffey, Loewy and Griffin, Business Communication: Process and Product. These are useful for additional examples and practical applications.

The expanded explanations, examples, remedies and supplementary network/negotiation concepts in this document are teaching-oriented elaborations. Where the syllabus specifies a topic, students should prioritize the syllabus wording and the main concepts explained in these notes.

15. Relevant questions from previous VTU papers

The following questions are taken from available VTU Managerial Communication papers under earlier schemes. They are included because they test concepts that overlap with the present Module 1 syllabus. The current 2026 scheme is different; these questions are useful for practice, not a prediction of the current examination.

15.1 VTU July/August 2022 – 20MBA16

- **3 marks:** What is Communication?
- **7 marks:** Classify Communication and explain with examples.
- **10 marks:** Elucidate the barriers in Communication.
- **3 marks:** What do you mean by Communication in a Cross Cultural Setting?
- **7 marks:** Explain the various Negotiation Strategies.
- **7 marks:** Explain the different formal communication channels in an organization.
- **7 marks:** Explain the various factors that affect negotiation.

15.2 VTU Model Question Paper – 20MBA16 (2021)

- **3 marks:** Define communication.
- **7 marks:** Explain the various negotiation strategies.
- **10 marks:** Discuss in detail the process of communication.
- **3 marks:** What is conflict?
- **7 marks:** Elaborate on the barriers in effective communication.
- **7 marks:** Explain the different formal communication channels in an organization.

15.3 Topics recurring across the available papers

- Meaning and definition of communication.
- Classification of communication.
- Communication process.
- Barriers to effective communication.
- Formal communication channels in organizations.
- Negotiation strategies and factors affecting negotiation.
- Communication in a cross-cultural setting.
- Meaning of conflict.

Source note: The 2022 paper is from the 2020 scheme (20MBA16). The model paper is also for 20MBA16. The present course is 3MBA106 under the 2026 scheme. Only questions directly relevant to Module 1 have been selected; questions on oral, non-verbal, written and employment communication have been excluded.